

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 4

APUSH-SAQ4-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Period 2: 1607–1754

Period: Period 2: 1607–1754

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of the Atlantic world argues that British North American colonies became increasingly tied to a wider imperial economy during the eighteenth century. According to this interpretation, trade in sugar, tobacco, rice, fish, timber, enslaved labor, and manufactured goods connected colonial households to markets across the Atlantic.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of colonial society argues that Atlantic commerce did more than move goods. According to this interpretation, imported tea, textiles, books, ceramics, and other consumer items helped colonists form new habits, social identities, and political expectations before the imperial crisis of the 1760s.

- (a) Describe one way British North American colonies were connected to the Atlantic economy before 1754.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid connection to the Atlantic economy, such as the export of tobacco, rice, indigo, fish, or timber; participation in Atlantic trade networks; reliance on enslaved African labor; importation of British manufactured goods; or participation in Caribbean trade.
- (b) 1 point: Explains evidence supporting Source A, such as mercantilism, Navigation Acts, the triangular trade, plantation exports, the slave trade, rum and sugar commerce, or colonial dependence on British markets and shipping.
- (c) 1 point: Explains evidence supporting Source B, such as the consumer revolution, imported tea and textiles, colonial newspapers and books, shared British cultural goods, homespun boycotts emerging later from consumer habits, or the use of consumer goods to express status and identity.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should show that eighteenth-century colonists were part of a wider Atlantic system. It should connect economic exchange to social and cultural change, rather than treating trade only as the movement of raw materials and finished goods.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ4-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Period 3: 1754–1800

Period: Period 3: 1754–1800

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A small farmer speaking at a state ratifying convention, New York, 1788.

“I do not deny that the Confederation has weaknesses. But a distant government with power to tax, raise armies, and command courts may forget the farmer as easily as Parliament once forgot the colonies. Before we surrender authority to a new frame of government, let us secure the liberties for which we fought: trial by jury, freedom of conscience, and protection from rulers who claim necessity as their excuse.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the debate described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the concerns expressed in the source influenced the early development of the United States government.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as weaknesses of the Articles of Confederation, Shays’ Rebellion, the Constitutional Convention, the ratification debates, Anti-Federalist opposition, or debates over federal taxation and standing armies.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s viewpoint as a small farmer or Anti-Federalist-leaning participant shaped concerns about centralized power, taxation, courts, standing armies, and the protection of individual liberties.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid influence, such as the adoption of the Bill of Rights, promises made during ratification, continuing debates over federalism, the creation of political factions, or limits placed on federal authority through constitutional amendments.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect the source to ratification debates, not simply identify it as “anti-government.” Strong answers will explain why some Americans feared centralized authority even after independence and how those concerns helped shape the Bill of Rights and early federal politics.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ4-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Period 9: 1980–Present

Period: Period 9: 1980–Present

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described poster created for this practice exam, modeled on late twentieth-century health activism but not copied from an actual poster.

The poster is titled “Health Care Is a Public Responsibility.” It shows a crowd of people standing outside a city hospital. Some hold signs reading “Fund Research,” “End Stigma,” “Patients Are People,” and “Listen to Affected Communities.” In the background, a newspaper headline reads, “Officials Debate Response to Epidemic.” The poster’s small print identifies it as being produced by a community health coalition in New York City, 1989.

(a) Describe one concern about American society or government reflected in the poster.

(b) Explain one historical factor that contributed to the rise of health-related activism in the 1980s and 1990s.

(c) Explain one way activism like that reflected in the poster affected politics, medicine, or public attitudes in the late twentieth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Describes a valid concern, such as inadequate government response to a public health crisis, stigma against affected communities, unequal access to medical care, lack of research funding, or the exclusion of patients from policy decisions.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor, such as the AIDS crisis, distrust of government response, activism by LGBTQ communities and allies, broader rights-based organizing, media coverage of epidemic disease, or frustration with slow medical research and drug approval processes.

(c) 1 point: Explains a relevant effect, such as increased research funding, changes in drug approval or clinical trial practices, greater public awareness of AIDS and patient rights, challenges to stigma, expansion of community health advocacy, or pressure on politicians and medical institutions.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should interpret the poster as evidence of late twentieth-century activism around health, rights, stigma, and government responsibility. It should connect activism to specific historical developments rather than giving a generic answer about “people wanting better health care.”

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ4-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which World War II transformed American society and the relationship between Americans and the federal government on the home front from 1941 to 1946.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Described poster issued by a federal wartime production office, United States, 1942.

Source Type: Described poster.

The poster shows a factory worker, a farmer, and a homemaker standing behind a large gear labeled “Production.” Above them are airplanes and cargo ships. At the bottom, smaller images show scrap metal collection, victory gardens, and a family buying war bonds. The poster’s message tells civilians that everyday labor and sacrifice are part of winning the war.

Sourcing Cues: The poster reflects federal efforts to mobilize civilians, coordinate production, and encourage voluntary cooperation with wartime economic goals.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated editorial from an African American labor newspaper, Detroit, 1942; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Newspaper-style excerpt.

“Defense plants call for workers, yet too many gates still close when a Black applicant arrives. We are told democracy is at stake overseas. Democracy is also at stake on the shop floor, in the union hall, and in the streetcar that carries workers home. Victory must mean the defeat of discrimination as well as the defeat of the Axis.”

Sourcing Cues: The editorial reflects African American wartime activism linking military victory abroad to civil rights and equal employment at home.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a Japanese American teenager to a former classmate, relocation center, Arizona, 1943; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“We recite the pledge at school here, though the guard tower stands beyond the fence. My parents say we must show loyalty, but I wonder why loyalty must be proven by people who have already lost their homes. Some boys talk of joining the army to prove what should never have been doubted.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects the perspective of a Japanese American youth confronting incarceration, loyalty demands, and wartime citizenship contradictions.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Labor-force data table created for this practice exam, United States, 1940–1946.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Changes in Women’s Wartime Employment.”

Year	Approximate number of women in paid labor force	Common areas of growth
1940	about 12 million	clerical work, service work, light manufacturing
1944	about 19 million	aircraft, shipbuilding, munitions, clerical work, government offices
1946	about 16 million	many women pushed out of wartime industrial jobs; clerical and service work remained important

A note beneath the table states: “Wartime labor demand expanded women’s paid work, but postwar reconversion limited some wartime gains.”

Sourcing Cues: The table highlights both change and limits in gender roles and wartime labor.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Summary of a wartime agricultural labor agreement between the United States and Mexico, 1943.

Source Type: Government policy summary.

The agreement allowed Mexican laborers to enter the United States temporarily to work in agriculture and railroad maintenance. Supporters argued that the program addressed wartime labor shortages and strengthened cooperation with Mexico. Critics warned that workers could face low wages, poor housing, and weak enforcement of contract protections.

Sourcing Cues: The summary reflects wartime labor needs, U.S.-Mexican cooperation, and unequal power in temporary labor programs.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Described ration book and household instruction sheet, United States, 1944.

Source Type: Described material-culture source.

The ration book contains stamps for meat, sugar, gasoline, and processed foods. The instruction sheet explains that families must plan meals, conserve fuel, and report lost stamps. A handwritten note on the back lists a household's weekly meals and reminders to save cooking fat and avoid unnecessary driving.

Sourcing Cues: The object shows how federal wartime policy entered everyday household routines and encouraged civilians to link consumption to national service.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Summary of congressional discussion of veterans' benefits, Washington, D.C., 1944.

Source Type: Legislative debate summary.

Supporters of a broad veterans' benefits bill argued that education assistance, home loans, and unemployment support would prevent a postwar crisis and reward military service. Some lawmakers worried about cost and administration, but most agreed that the federal government had a responsibility to help veterans return to civilian life.

Sourcing Cues: The discussion reflects expanding expectations that the federal government would support citizens after national service.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which World War II transformed American society and the relationship between Americans and the federal government on the home front from 1941 to 1946. The thesis must make an argument, such as that the war greatly expanded federal influence over work, consumption, civil rights claims, and postwar benefits while leaving racial, gender, and citizenship inequalities unresolved.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as the Great Depression and New Deal, isolationism before Pearl Harbor, total war mobilization, industrial production, the Great Migration, Jim Crow, women's prewar labor roles, or wartime fears after Pearl Harbor.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about wartime production, federal mobilization, civil rights activism, Japanese American incarceration, women's labor, Mexican labor migration, rationing, or veterans' benefits.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as Executive Order 8802, A. Philip Randolph's March on Washington Movement, the Fair Employment Practices Committee, Rosie the Riveter, War Production Board, Office of Price Administration, *Korematsu v. United States*, the 442nd Regimental Combat Team, Zoot Suit Riots, Double V campaign, or GI Bill effects on education and housing.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point

of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze the poster's purpose as federal mobilization propaganda, the African American newspaper's civil rights perspective, the Japanese American letter's challenge to wartime loyalty assumptions, the ration book as evidence of federal power in daily life, or the veterans' debate as evidence of changing expectations of government responsibility.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that wartime mobilization expanded opportunities for some groups while intensifying coercion for others, distinguishing temporary wartime changes from longer-term postwar effects, or showing how claims of democracy abroad encouraged demands for democracy at home.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that World War II transformed American society and federal power to a large extent through production mobilization, rationing, labor demand, civil rights activism, migration, and veterans' benefits. However, it should also recognize contradictions: Japanese American incarceration violated citizenship rights, women's industrial gains were partly reversed after the war, Mexican laborers faced exploitation, and African Americans continued to confront discrimination. Useful document groupings include federal mobilization and household sacrifice, race and citizenship, labor and gender, migration and agricultural work, and postwar benefits. Relevant outside evidence could include Executive Order 8802, FEPC, Rosie the Riveter, Korematsu, Double V, the War Production Board, the Office of Price Administration, or the GI Bill.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ4-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Period 6: 1865–1898

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the late nineteenth century through World War II, industrial growth, corporate consolidation, labor conflict, economic depression, reform movements, and wartime mobilization repeatedly raised questions about the proper role of the federal government in the economy. Americans debated whether government should protect property and markets, regulate corporations, support workers and farmers, stabilize prices, or directly manage production in times of crisis.

Evaluate the extent to which the role of the federal government in the United States economy changed from 1865 to 1945.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent of change in the federal government's role in the economy from 1865 to 1945. The thesis must make an argument about continuity, change, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to federal economic policy, such as post-Civil War industrialization, railroad expansion, laissez-faire ideas, labor conflict, Populism, Progressivism, World War I mobilization, the Great Depression, New Deal reforms, or World War II production.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as land grants to railroads, protective tariffs, the Homestead Act, Interstate Commerce Act, Sherman Antitrust Act, Pullman Strike, Progressive regulation, Federal Reserve Act, wartime economic boards, New Deal agencies, Social Security Act, Wagner Act, Fair Labor Standards Act, or War Production Board. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about continuity and change in federal economic power.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how the federal government moved from promoting markets and infrastructure while often defending property rights toward a larger regulatory, welfare, and planning role by the New Deal and World War II, while still protecting capitalism and private enterprise.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that federal intervention existed before the New Deal but changed in scale and purpose, distinguishing regulation from ownership, comparing responses to labor and corporations, or showing that crisis conditions expanded federal power more rapidly than ordinary political debate.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should not claim that the federal government had no economic role before the Great Depression. It should recognize earlier federal support for railroads, tariffs, land policy, and corporate development while arguing that the New Deal and World War II greatly expanded regulation, welfare policy, labor protections, and production planning. Strong responses will explain both continuity in support for capitalism and change in the scale and expectations of federal economic action.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ4

· APUSH-SAQ4-001: Unit 2; Period 2: 1607–1754; perspectives include modern secondary historians of Atlantic economic integration and colonial consumer culture; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast Atlantic trade networks with consumer habits and social identity formation; historical development is eighteenth-century Atlantic commerce, mercantilism, slave-based trade, and colonial consumer revolution; reasoning path is comparison connecting economic exchange to cultural and political expectations; misconception targeted is treating colonial trade only as raw exports without social or cultural effects.

· APUSH-SAQ4-002: Unit 3; Period 3: 1754–1800; perspective is small farmer / Anti-Federalist-leaning speaker at a ratifying convention; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes fear of centralized taxation, standing armies, federal courts, and threats to liberties; historical development is the Constitution ratification debate and demand for a Bill of Rights; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to federalism, liberty, and post-Revolution distrust of concentrated power; misconception targeted is assuming all supporters of independence automatically supported a stronger federal Constitution.

· APUSH-SAQ4-003: Unit 9; Period 9: 1980–Present; perspectives include health activists, affected communities, medical researchers, public officials, LGBTQ communities and allies, and patients seeking recognition; non-text source type is described activist poster; visual/data/map pattern is late twentieth-century public health protest imagery with hospital, crowd, newspaper headline, and advocacy signs; historical development is AIDS-era health activism, patient rights, stigma reduction, and pressure for research funding; reasoning path is causation linking public health crisis,

community organizing, and policy or medical change; misconception targeted is treating health policy as separate from social movements, rights claims, and government accountability.

· APUSH-DBQ4-001: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; DBQ topic is World War II home-front transformation of American society and the relationship between Americans and the federal government from 1941 to 1946; document types include described federal production poster, African American labor newspaper editorial, Japanese American relocation-center letter, women's labor-force data table, U.S.-Mexico labor agreement summary, ration book/material-culture source, and congressional veterans' benefits debate summary; document perspectives include federal mobilizers, African American workers, Japanese American incarcerated citizens, women workers, Mexican laborers, households, lawmakers, veterans, and wartime administrators; main argument paths include federal production mobilization, rationing and household sacrifice, civil rights claims, Japanese American incarceration, women's industrial employment, Bracero labor, and veterans' benefits; outside evidence possibilities include Executive Order 8802, A. Philip Randolph, FEPC, Rosie the Riveter, War Production Board, Office of Price Administration, Korematsu, 442nd Regimental Combat Team, Zoot Suit Riots, Double V campaign, and GI Bill effects; sourcing opportunities include propaganda purpose, African American wartime rights claims, youth perspective from incarceration, data showing temporary and lasting labor changes, material-culture evidence of rationing, and lawmakers' expectations of federal responsibility; visual/data/map types include described wartime production poster, women's labor-force data table, and ration book material object.

· APUSH-LEQ4-001: Units 6–7; Periods 6–7 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is change in the federal government's role in the economy from 1865 to 1945; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include railroad land grants, tariffs, Homestead Act, Interstate Commerce Act, Sherman Antitrust Act, Pullman Strike, Progressive regulation, Federal Reserve Act, World War I economic mobilization, New Deal agencies, Social Security Act, Wagner Act, Fair Labor Standards Act, and War Production Board; complexity path is explaining that federal economic intervention existed before the New Deal but changed in scale, purpose, and public expectation during depression and war while still preserving capitalism; misconception targeted is assuming laissez-faire meant no federal economic role before the 1930s.